

portfolio

Narita Reyes Ico
MArch, MLA, BEnDs
06.2020 - 04.2026
Selected works



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spring 2021

about the designer

Narita (she/her) is a Filipina-Canadian designer currently living and learning as a guest on the unceded and ancestral land of the xʷməθkʷəy̓əm (Musqueam) people where she is a recent graduate of the Master of Architecture and Landscape Architecture Dual Degree program at the University of British Columbia. She is the recipient of the 2021 IOC IPC IAKS Bronze Medal Architecture & Design Award for Young Professionals. She has featured works in the 2023 Venice Biennale under the Architects Against Housing Alienation collective and has completed fellowships with Canada’s Pavilion at the Venice Biennale (Italy) in 2025 and the Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity (Alberta, Canada) in 2026.

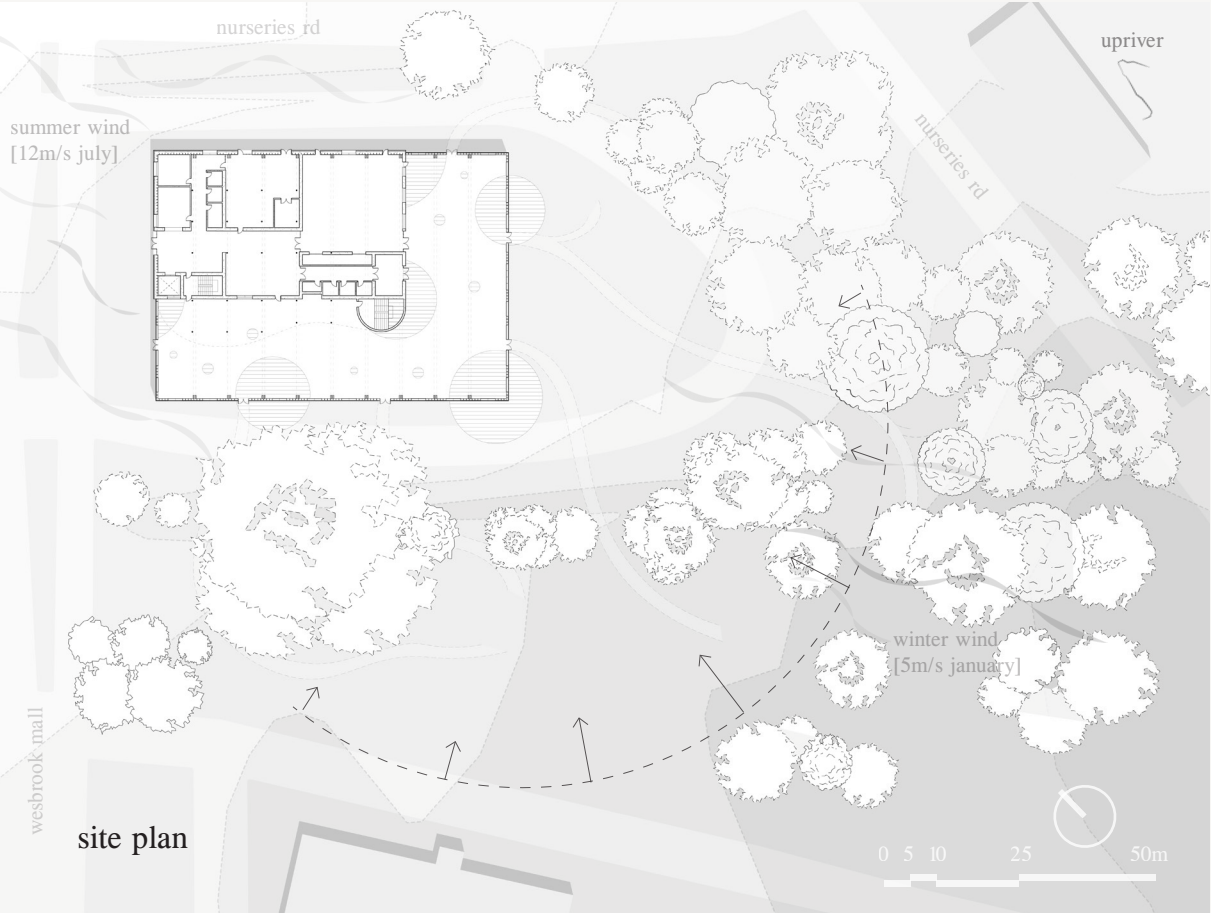
Her work is grounded in cultural knowledge with a focus on handcrafts combined with technical skills. She believes that designing for site requires architects to engage with interconnected systems, including the people, land, and waters.

seed to table

Location: UBC, Vancouver, BC
Course: Comprehensive Design Studio
Date: 01.2024 - 04.2024
Professor: Joanne Gates
Collaborator: Robyn Adams

Seed to Table adaptively reuses UBC’s Opera Warehouse into a greenhouse research facility focused on food security. Located between UBC Farm and Pacific Spirit Park, this building aims to foster community, connect the local environment, and nurture practices of growing, research and learning.

This project will be featured in the upcoming issue of Site Magazine, to be released in July 2026.



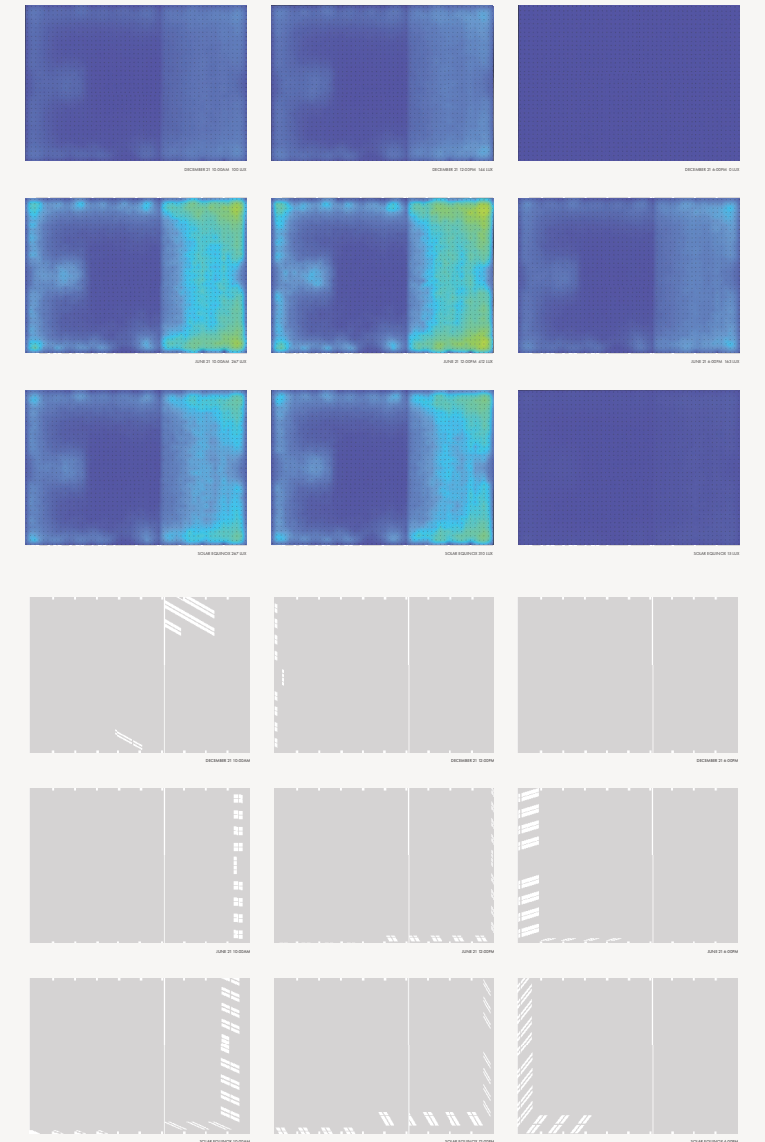


upriver

Upriver refers to the Lower Fraser Salish's direction of Stó:lo (the Fraser River) that feeds the surrounding land. It also aligns with north.

building analysis

Through simulations in Climate Studio, we were able to understand lighting and climate conditions within the building. This particularly supported the way in which we laid out and planned for the community gardening areas as seen in the watercoloured areas on the ground plan (left).



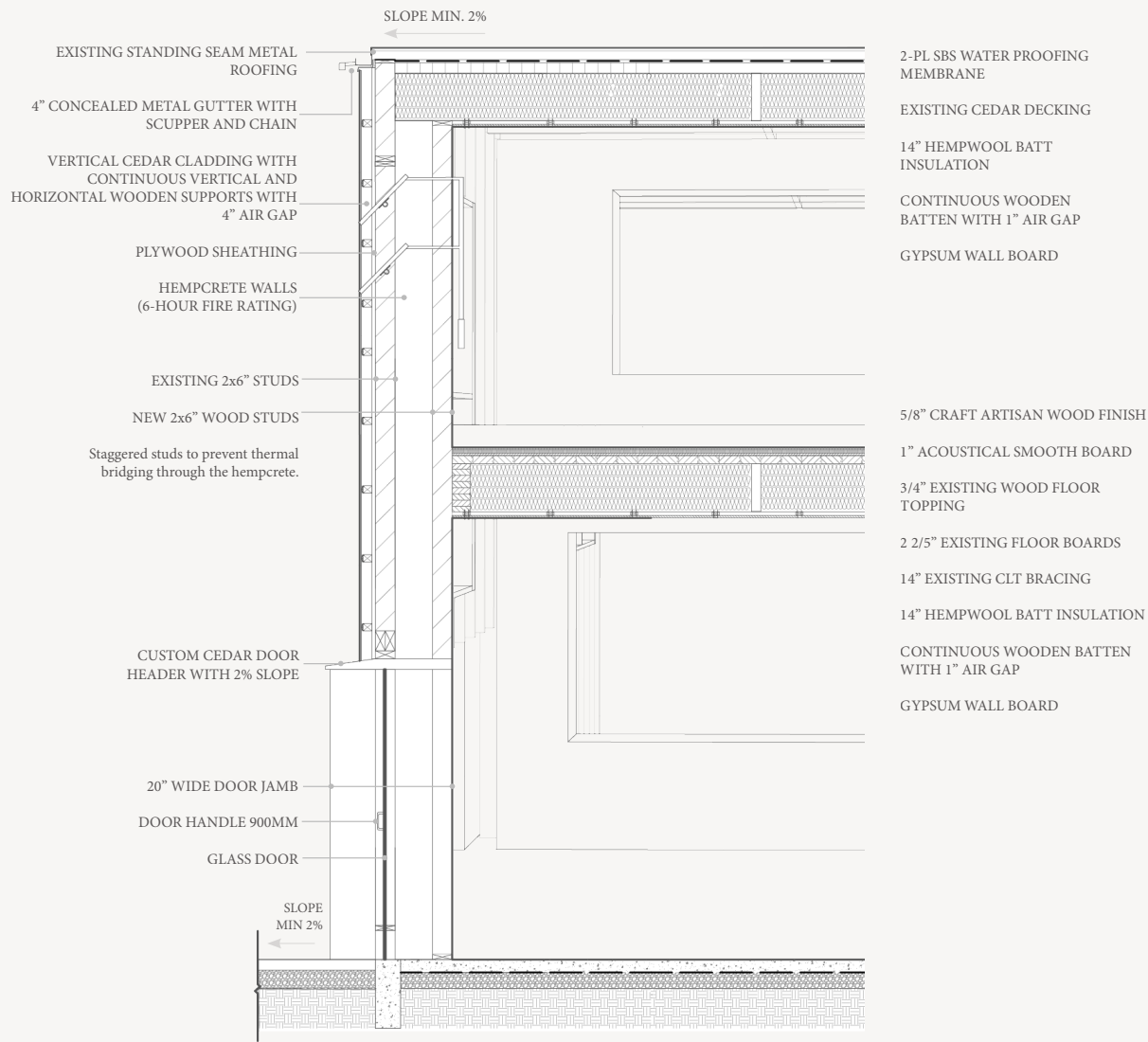
*Plan and Section by Narita Reyes Ico
Climate simulations by Robyn Adams*



longitudinal section

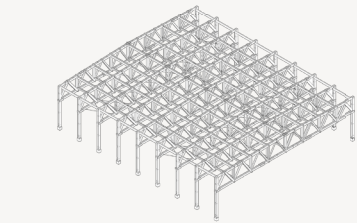
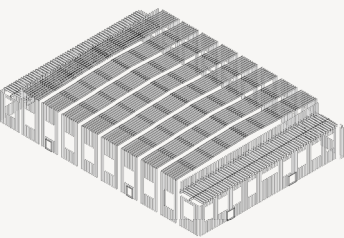
Detail Sections

by Narita Reyes Ico



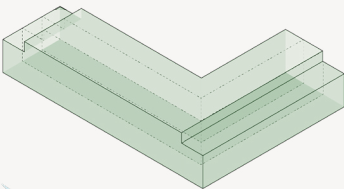
main design elements

Diagrams by Narita Reyes Ico



1. Reuse of Existing Structure

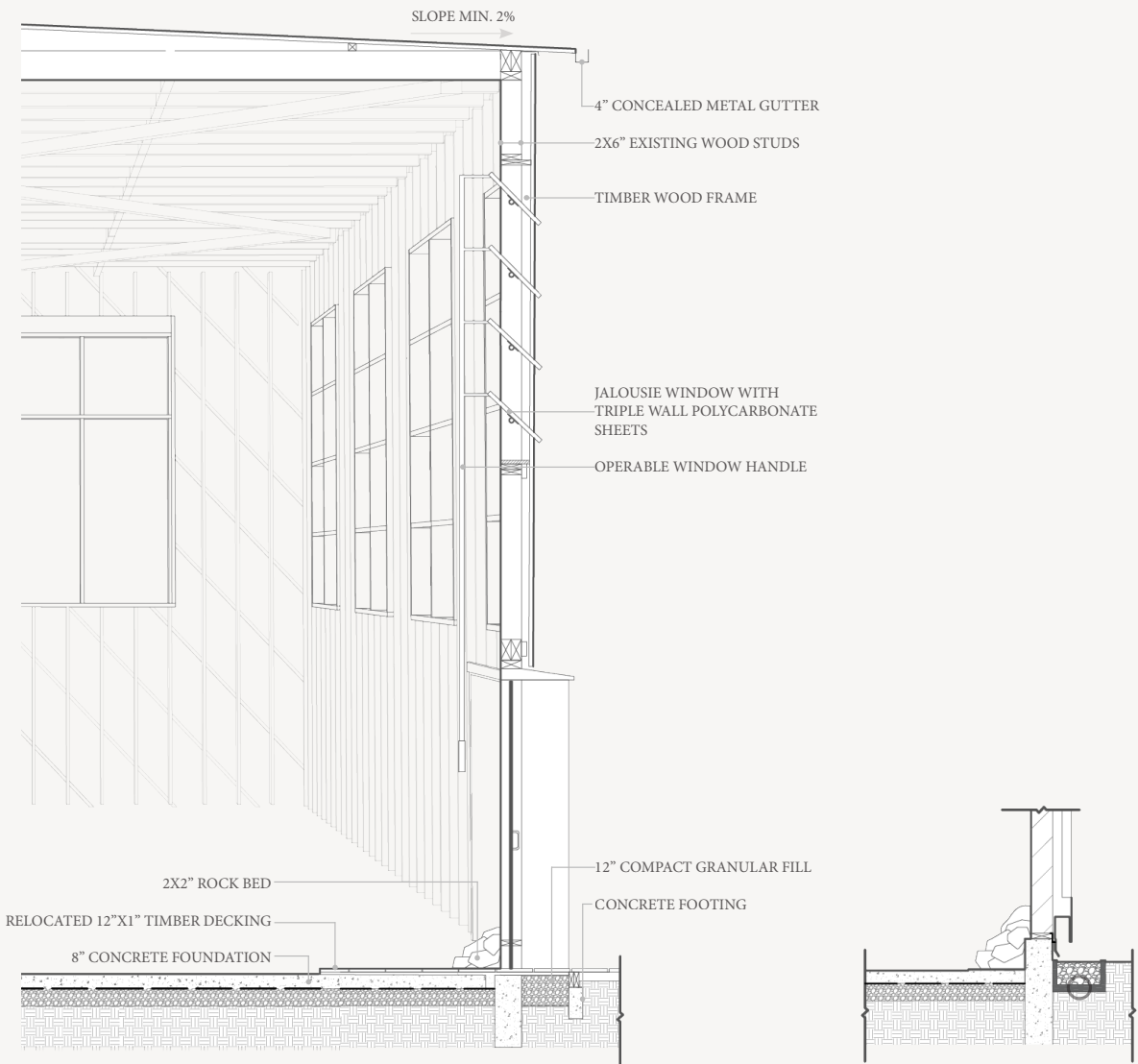
The existing studs, joists, columns, beams, mezzanine, and roof are reused.



2. Greenhouse as Thermal Gradient

Rocks and hempcrete slowly emit heat built throughout the day, into the greenhouse at night.

Greenhouse Facade Section



3. Hempcrete Core

Hempcrete is used as insulation and thermal mass. It is a well ventilated material, with a good fire rating, and is carbon negative.

4. Double-loaded Arrangement

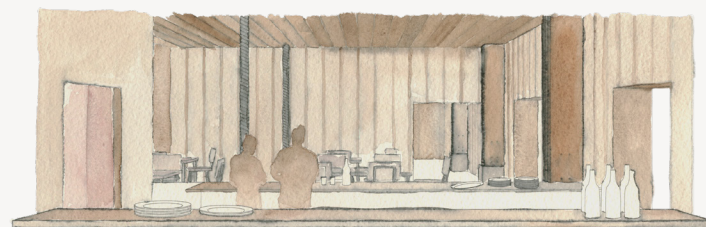
The central corridors align with the direction of incoming summer and winter winds to encourage ventilation.

5. Rock Beds

Rock beds provide thermal comfort and regulation to their surroundings.



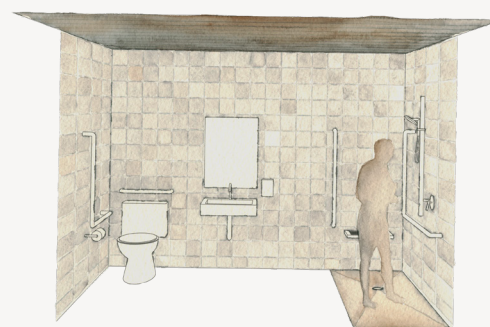
seed



restoring



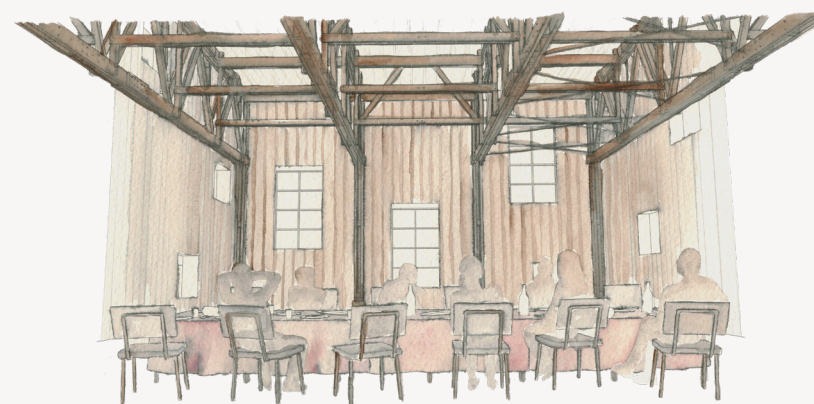
learning



cleansing

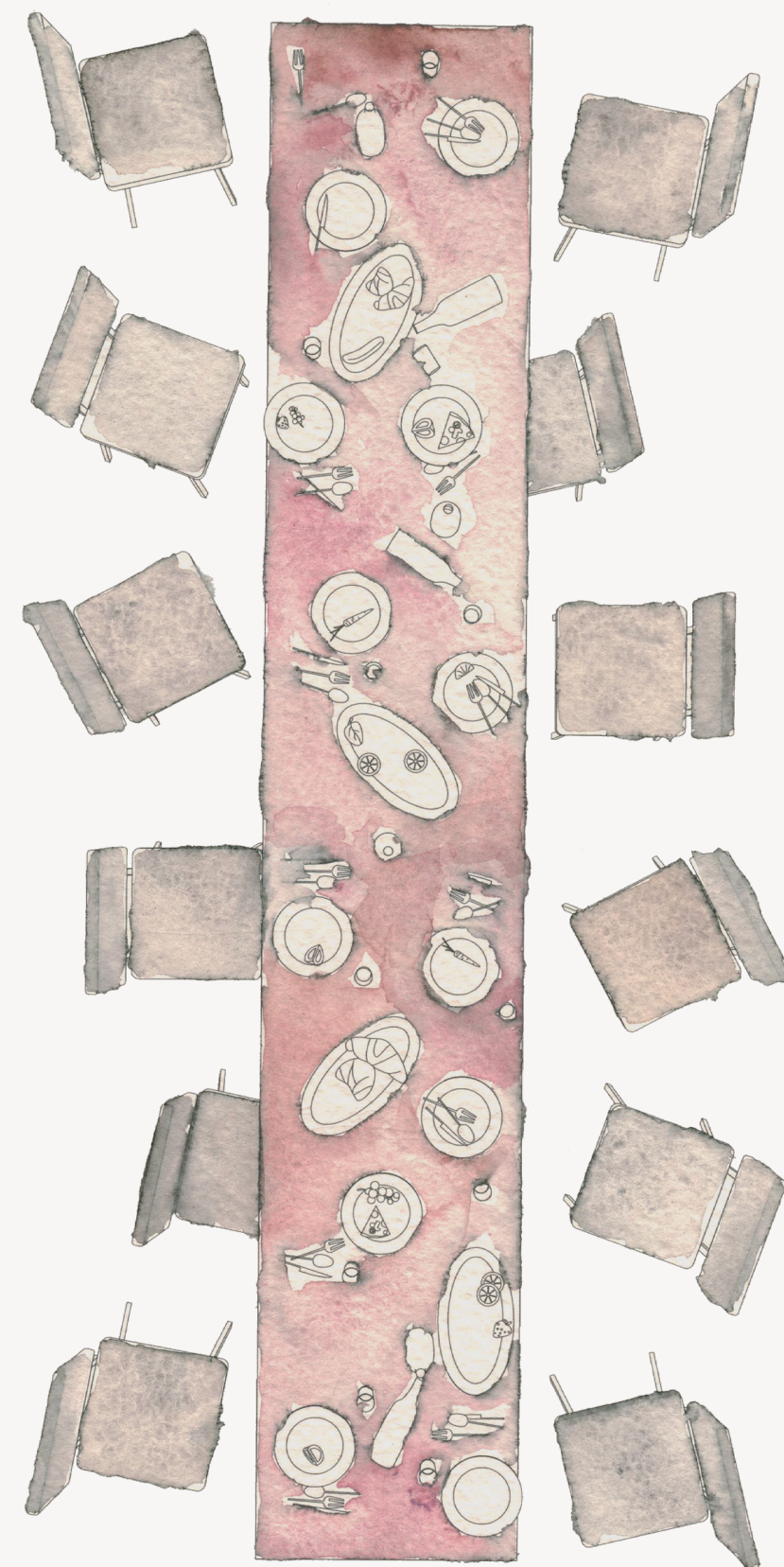


growing



gathering

Watercolour renders
by Narita Reyes Ico



to table

maillardville community centre

Location: Coquitlam, BC
Year: 06. 2020 - 08. 2022
Size: 20,000 sq. ft.
Architect: TKA+D
Builder: Ledcor

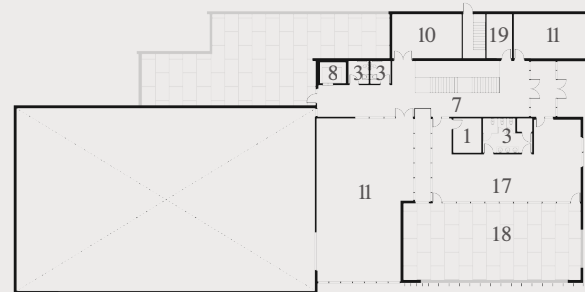
Maillardville Community Centre is located in the historic Francophone Area of Coquitlam. The facility features the City's first dedicated gymnasium, children's program area with large covered outdoor space, multipurpose rooms, sprung-floor active studio, seniors lounge, and other amenities.

I was responsible for the construction coordination on behalf of the City as well as building launch to operations.

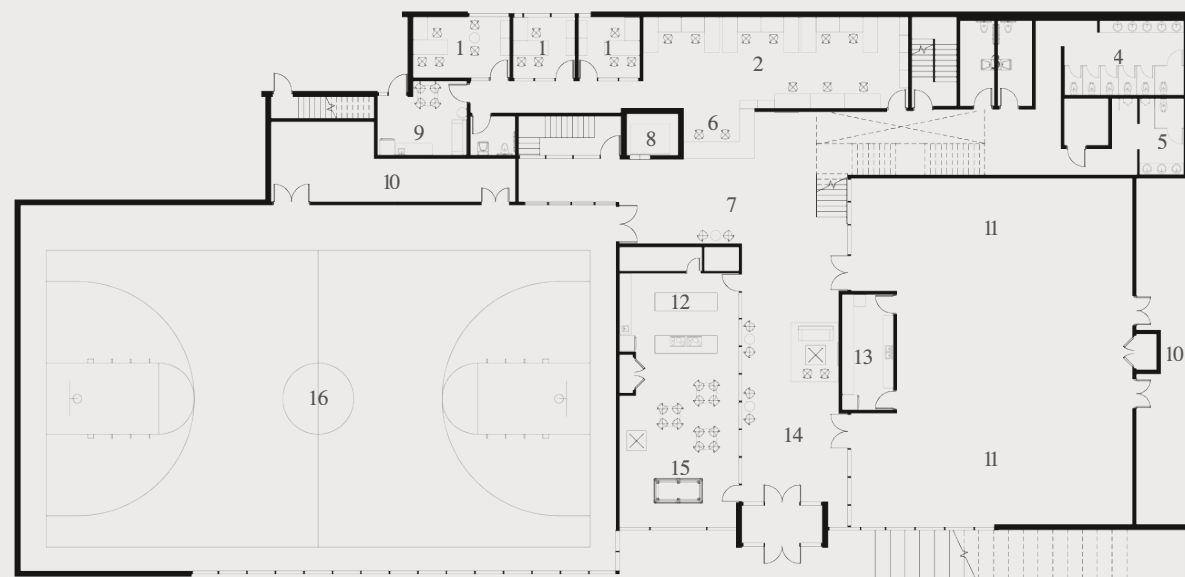
Render by Narita Reyes Ico



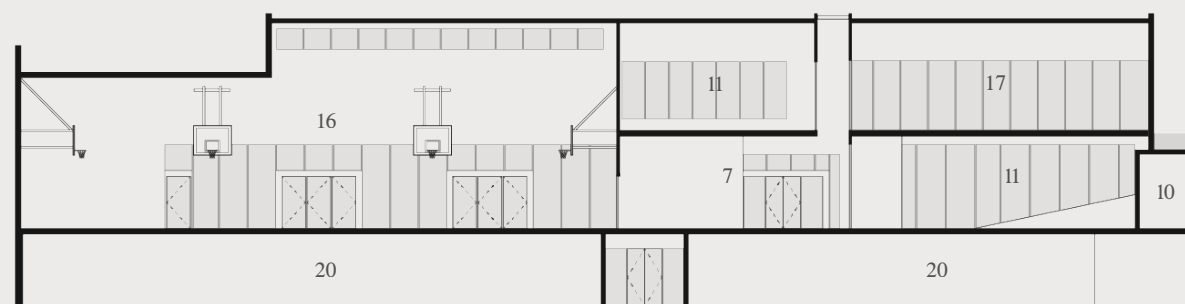
- | | |
|---------------|-------------------------------|
| 1 office | 11 multi-purpose room |
| 2 admin | 12 demo kitchen |
| 3 change/wc | 13 catering kitchen |
| 4 women's wc | 14 lobby |
| 5 men's wc | 15 flex lounge |
| 6 reception | 16 gymnasium |
| 7 circulation | 17 interior child programming |
| 8 elevator | 18 exterior child programming |
| 9 staff room | 19 server room |
| 10 storage | 20 parkade |



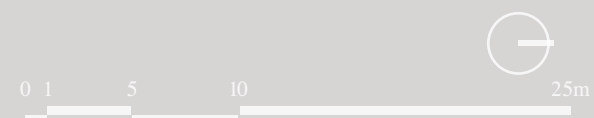
Second Level Plan



Ground Plan



Longitudinal Section

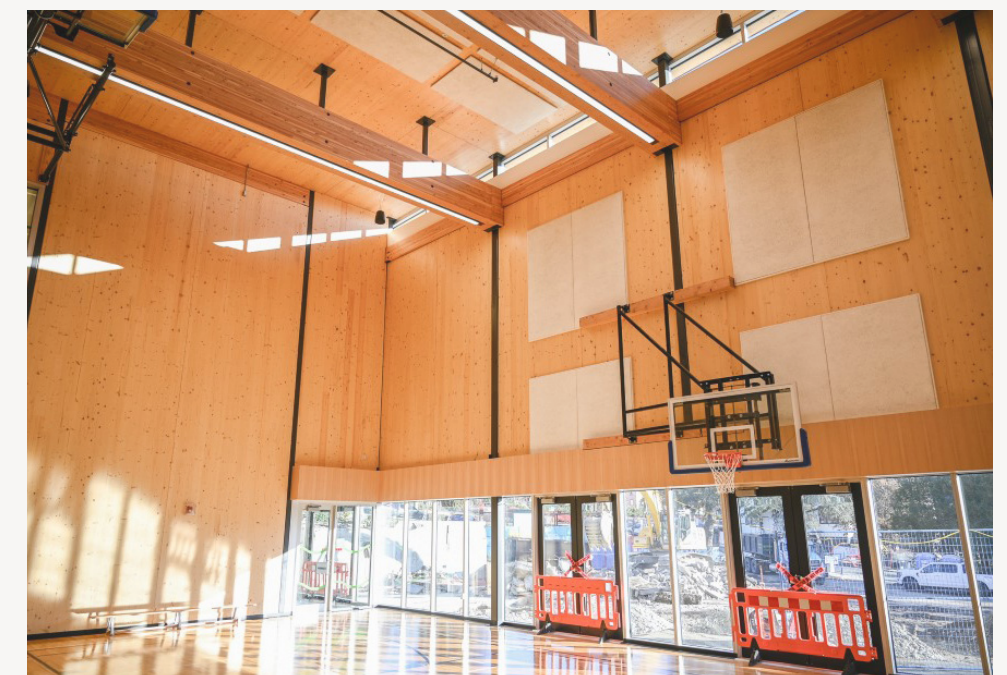


Exterior of entrance



Second floor hallway

Ground floor gymnasium



provisional structures

Location: Regina, SK
Year: 06. 2020 - 08. 2020
Firm: Goodweather
Collaborator: Michael Lis
Artist: Carmen Papalia

Michael Lis (Goodweather Director) and I collaborated with Vancouver-based artist, Carmen Papalia. The Provisional Structure draws on his experience as a non-visual learner, a term he chooses to identify with over the medicalizing terminology of “blind” or “visually impaired.” I was responsible for translating the real-world idea into a hand-scaled model that communicated the concept and physical structure to Carmen. This was an iterative process that involved leaning into senses beyond sight such as sound, hearing, smell, and touch.

The exhibition was on display at the MacKenzie Art Gallery in Regina, Saskatchewan from June 12th to October 17th of 2021.



Photo by Don Hall, Photographer



*Photo by Michael Lis
Model by Narita Reyes Ico*

Dome

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A 3D perspective view of a spiral staircase structure. The staircase is a double helix, with two separate paths spiraling around a central void. It features a complex support system with numerous vertical columns and diagonal bracing members. The staircase is shown in a light brown color, while the support structure is in grey. The view is from an elevated angle, looking down at the spiral.

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Steel Piping

This isometric view shows the completed wooden structure. It consists of a rectangular frame with a central square opening. The frame is made of thick wooden planks. The base is a flat wooden board. In the center of the base, there is a circular arrangement of small wooden pieces, likely representing the 'seeds' mentioned in the text. The entire structure is shown in a perspective view, highlighting its three-dimensional nature.

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Overall dimensions:
22" x 20" x 6"



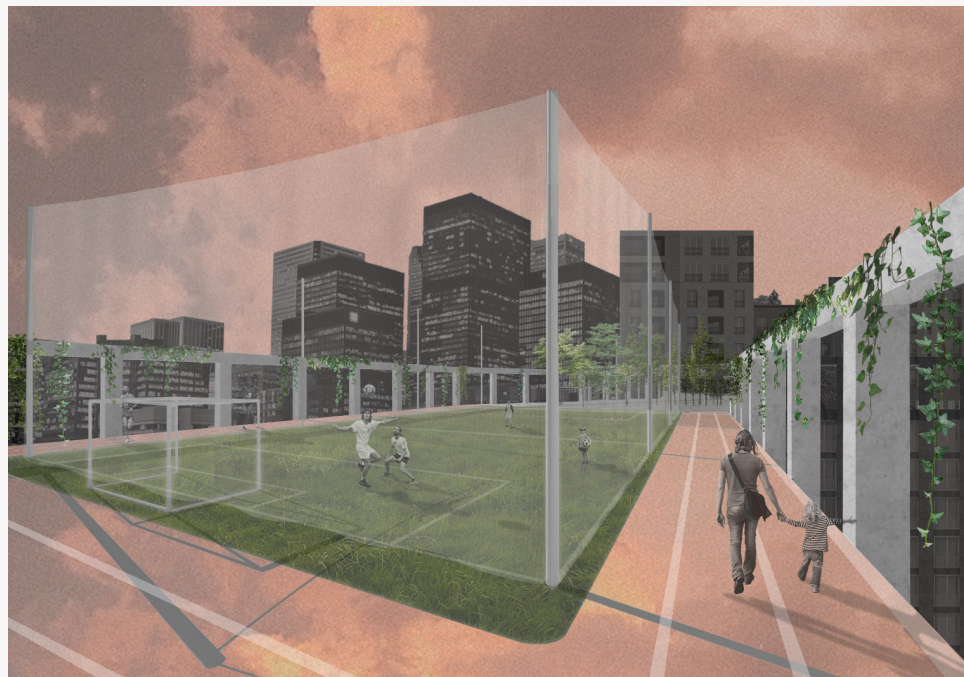
Non-visual artist, Carmen Papalia, understanding the gallery installation's physical structure solely through touch. Model by Narita Reyes Ico. (left)

the granville gateway

Location: Vancouver, BC
 Year: 01.2021 - 04.2021
 Award: IOC IPC IAKS Bronze Medal
 Architecture & Design Award for
 Young Professionals 2021

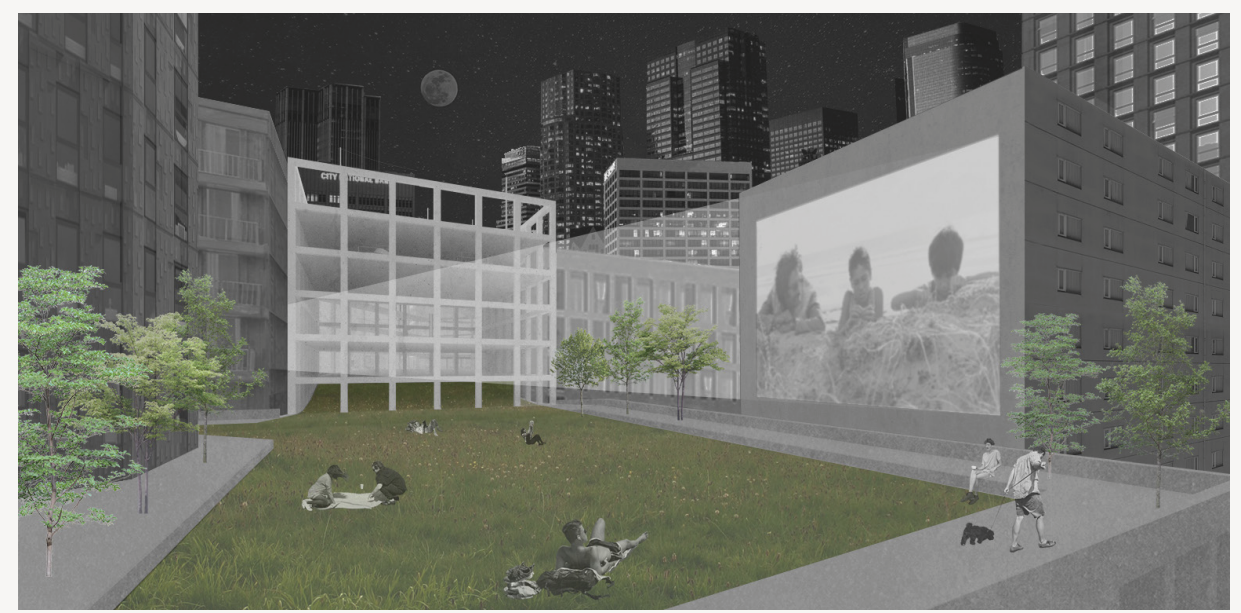
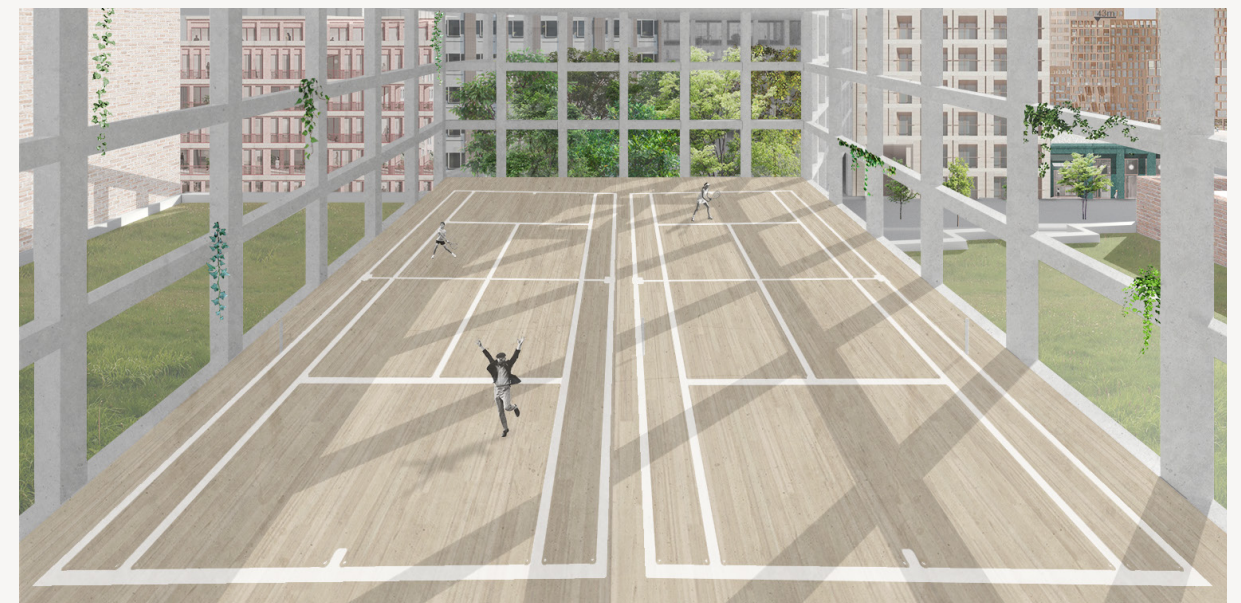


The Granville Gateway is an entrance into one of the most iconic areas of Vancouver, the Entertainment District. It transforms two underutilized parking lots and their adjacent green spaces into a cohesive community and recreation centre. Through the rehabilitation and revitalization of disused spaces, this projects explores how future urban environments can foster a balanced relationship between nature and the city. The floating forest hovers above the street and is an elevated escape from the hustle of the City. The Granville Gateway is not only a recreation centre, but a congregational space for social and community interaction.





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|-----------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1. Parking | 5. Reception | 9. SW Park | 13. Sports Field |
| 2. NE Park | 6. Granville Street | 10. Tennis Court | 14. Rooftop Lounge |
| 3. Playground | 7. Public Plaza | 11. Gymnasium | 15. Sports Court |
| 4. Bike Storage | 8. Indoor Atrium | 12. Fitness Centre | 16. Running Track |





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|------------------|---------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 1. NE Park | 5. Universal Stalls | 9. Rooftop Lounge | 13. Fitness Centre |
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